Habit Gate

UI/UX & Reliability Review

Clear access. Trustworthy verification.

Recoverable rules.

Prepared for	Quan and CEO review
Review date	18 October 2026
Installed baseline	macOS 1.4.0 (build 10); Chrome extension 1.1.1
Document revision	1.0
Review purpose	Assess implementation against the supplied improvement requirements and identify remaining public-release gates
Recommendation	Continue a small private pilot; public release remains gated

Verified on this Mac

Messenger redirects to Habit Gate's blocked page. An unrelated HTTPS page remains usable. Fresh Chrome 1.1.1 reports all six domains permitted and rules installed. The saved native policy is unchanged.

Read alongside the engineering baseline

The earlier 32-page Product & Engineering Review describes 1.3.0 (8). This addendum supersedes its UI, recovery and current validation status. Historical performance measurements have not been re-labelled as 1.4.0 results.

1 Executive decision

The update addresses uncertainty in four places: the access decision, whether progress was freshly verified, whether a saved rule is active, and whether a configured target is actually protected. It preserves the existing blue/charcoal design and lightweight architecture.

1.1 Ready for continued private testing

- Separate access, Habitify verification and protection coverage in Overview, Today and Chrome.
- Named active/scheduled essentials, exact effective dates, setup drafts and review before activation.
- Immediate website/app additions, next-4-AM removals, and deferred essential-habit edits.
- Explicit policy recovery, failed-save handling, reconnect and confirmed credential deletion.
- Accurate refresh feedback, origin-only blocked destinations and relevant permission recovery.

1.2 Evidence at the review baseline

Measure	Result and scope
Automated checks	61 Swift + 20 browser tests passed; 12 shared proof fixtures
Installed build	Release build, ad-hoc signature and native protocol checks pass
Live Habitify	Verified at 14:30 local; habit date 18 October; 1/7 complete; access locked
Chrome coverage	Fresh 1.1.1 report: six domains, no missing permissions, rules installed; Incognito off
Live navigation	Messenger blocked; unrelated HTTPS page usable after extension repair
Policy preservation	Seven active/eight scheduled essentials, six domains, five Mac apps; semantically unchanged
Performance	No current-build profile; CPU and combined-memory targets not established for 1.4.0

CEO review request

Approve continued private testing and assign engineering/QA owners to installation, end-to-end acceptance and accessibility. Do not expand the feature set before proving the daily block/verify/unlock/relock loop.

1.3 Scope

Habitify remains the read-only source of truth. There is no pause, exercise bypass, habit editor, rewards, analytics or AI. Chrome-first support remains; Safari is deferred. Foreground apps are hidden without force-quitting sessions. Other browsers, unconfigured profiles, disabled extensions and quitting Habit Gate remain voluntary-enforcement limits.

2 Business rules and effective times

2.1 Explicit product decision

The supplied document describes all later changes as scheduled. The user's newer explicit timing decision overrides that passage:

Change	Takes effect	User-visible meaning
Initial reviewed choices	On activation	Essentials, websites and optional apps reviewed together
Essential-habit edits	Next local 4 AM	Today's commitment stays unchanged
Website/app additions	On save	New distractions join today's gate
Website/app removals	Next local 4 AM	Removing a target cannot pause today's protection
Mixed target save	Add now; remove later	A target added earlier today also stays until the next boundary

Chrome normally receives changes within its 30-second local-state cycle. New custom domains require permission. On save specifies policy activation, not zero-latency browser propagation. Target-only edits preserve valid same-day completion proof and cannot accidentally activate pending habit edits.

2.2 Access decision

1. Resolve the habit date using a Gregorian calendar in the Mac's local timezone.
2. Before 4 AM, query the previous date. Habitify still uses midnight: late-night check-ins must be recorded against the displayed date.
3. Evaluate supported selected essentials scheduled for that date.
4. Require every due essential to have status `completed`. Partial, skipped, failed, missing and unknown do not count.
5. A verified rest day may unlock. Missing, archived or unsupported selections are configuration problems.
6. A later successful verification of an undo locks access again.

2.3 Offline and expiry

Previously verified complete/rest-day proof may remain usable offline only until its original 4 AM expiry. Errors do not extend it. Without valid proof, access stays locked. Time, offset, habit identity, expiry and contradictory status are checked by native and browser policy.

No settings bypass

Recovery restores reviewed policy without adding general emergency access or silently resetting an active commitment. The same Mac user can still remove voluntary components; this is not tamper resistance.

3 User flow and responsibilities

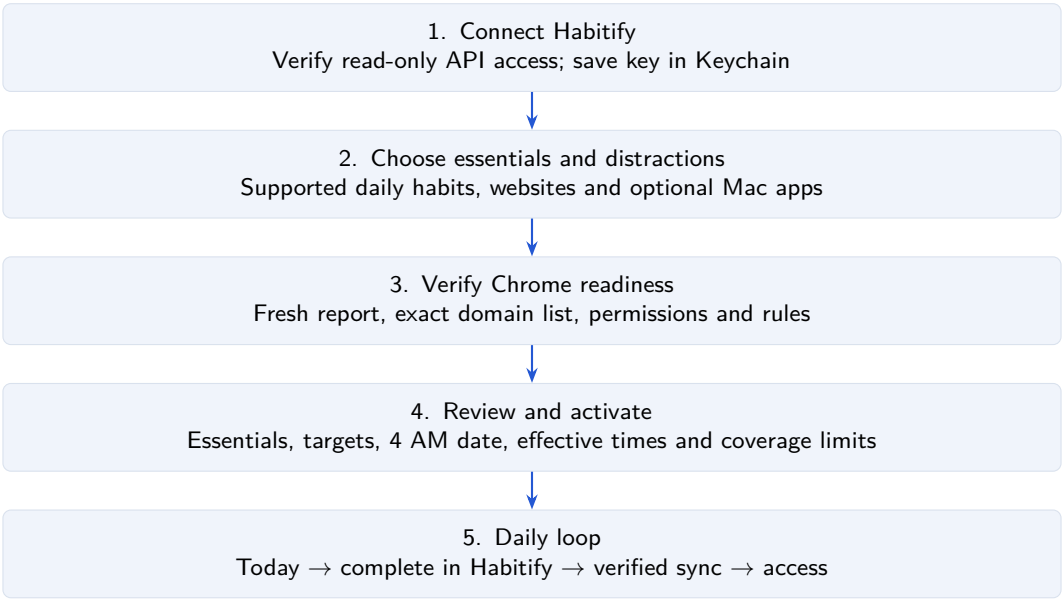


Figure 1: *Onboarding establishes a reviewed policy before normal daily operation.*

The preactivation check establishes native/permission/rule readiness. The extension's real redirect test runs *after activation while locked*. This review does not claim a blocked navigation before activation.

Surface	Responsibility
Today panel	Quick access state, remaining habits, date, sync health and Open Habitify
Overview	Full progress and separate coverage summary; links to issues
Rules screens	Active vs scheduled choices, input validation and effective time
Chrome blocked page	Why locked, what remains, Open Habitify, accurate Sync and safe Back/Continue
Mac app notice	Identify hidden app, explain session preservation and Return to Work
Extension popup	Compact access/connection state; expanded profile diagnostics and test

4 Architecture and verification flow

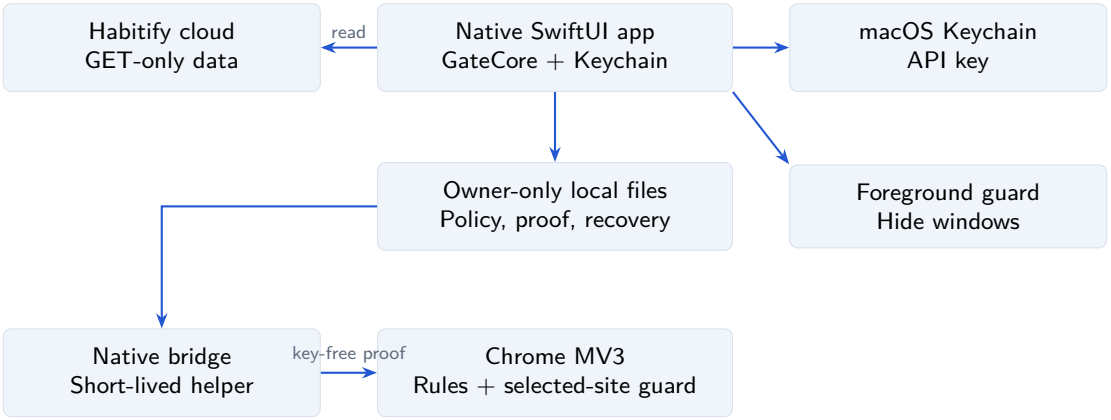


Figure 2: *One native process, a short-lived bridge and Chrome; no added daemon or external package.*

4.1 Manual sync sequence

1. Chrome sends refresh with key-free profile coverage.
2. The bridge asks the native app to verify and returns the current snapshot, which may be cached.
3. The interface shows requested/checking, without claiming a fresh successful sync.
4. Native fetches the dated journal and catalog, validates policy, and atomically caches the decision.
5. Chrome reads again. Only a newer verification timestamp confirms fresh success; errors show failure or previously verified proof.

4.2 Simplicity and privacy

Habitify checks remain every 60 seconds while awake, Chrome local reads every 30 seconds and native housekeeping every five seconds. No extra polling loop was introduced.

The API key stays in Keychain and is not sent to Chrome. Blocked destinations retain only the website origin, dropping path/query/fragment and embedded credentials. The cached snapshot includes app names/bundle identifiers for recovery; that metadata is also present in bridge responses. Minimizing it further is a future privacy-hardening task.

5 Feature specifications and traceability

IDs correspond to the supplied improvement document. Implemented means code and controlled validation exist; live and usability release gates remain.

ID	Implemented behavior	Evidence / remaining work
UI-01	Access, sync and coverage separated; one progress display and next action	Installed Overview; comprehension pilot pending
UI-02	Active/scheduled names, exact time, selected-first rows and supported-goal guidance	Installed habits; long-content fixtures
UI-03	Per-profile version/native/permissions/rules/private/test status; domain validation	Fresh 1.1.1 report; store installation pending
UI-04	Watching vs verified hiding, per-app errors, foreground-only wording	Guard tests; full current-build app pilot pending
UI-05	Prerequisites, Disconnect/Reconnect/Delete key; focused Preferences	Fake-vault tests; no live credential deletion
UI-06	Distinct Today, Overview, popup and blocked-surface responsibilities	Current screenshots; accessibility audit pending
RULE-01	Habit date, next 4 AM, Gregorian date/offset/expiry checks	Boundary/DST/timezone tests pass
RULE-02	Setup draft, active/scheduled confirmations and timing override	Target/policy timing tests pass
RULE-03	All due complete; rest vs missing; verified undo relocks	Shared native/browser proof cases
RULE-04	Requested/checking/new verification/failure/prior proof	Feedback and refresh regressions
RULE-05	Reported coverage and hide outcomes; voluntary scope	Native coverage and guard wording
RULE-06	Validated policy/backup, explicit restore and failed saves	Isolated faults pass; device trial pending

5.1 Flow requirements

ID	Implementation	Limit or next evidence
FLOW-01	Draft setup, exact-domain readiness, review and activation	Live redirect test after activation; public install pending
FLOW-02	Login to Today, complete in Habitify, verify and unlock	Live complete/undo cycle pending
FLOW-03	Primary Open Habitify, accurate Sync, safe Back and Continue	Messenger redirect; complete-path fixture only
FLOW-04	App name, temporary hide explanation, preserved session, safe exit	Guard tests; five-app live matrix pending
FLOW-05	Cause, affected protection and contextual recovery	Independent recovery usability test pending

5.2 Acceptance contracts

Area	Required behavior
Activation	Verified key, reviewed essentials and a report under 150 seconds old for exact domains, with permissions and rules ready
Target save	Additions today; removals next 4 AM; pending essentials unaffected
Fresh sync	No new-success message until verification time advances beyond request baseline
Proof agreement	Same date, offset, expiry and habit-set interpretation; contradictory completion cannot unlock
Permission request	Missing domains only, declared HTTP/HTTPS origins, direct user-click request
Return navigation	Continue rechecks proof/destination; no private path/query retained; safe Back fallback
Storage	Corruption is not new install; failed save does not mutate active state
Credentials	Disconnect invalidates outstanding reads; deletion targets only this app's item

Deliberate exclusions

No Habitify writes, bypass, forced termination, additional browser integration or speculative performance refactor. The simple scheduling model is retained.

6 Failure handling and recovery

Condition	Access	Explanation / recovery
Due essential incomplete	Locked	Remaining habits; Open Habitify
All complete / verified rest	Valid until expiry	Continue; show date/reset
Network/server failure	Prior valid proof only	Failure and last success; Retry
Missing/unsupported habit	Locked	Review essentials; habit timing applies
Policy unreadable	Locked; known targets	Review recovery copy; explicit restore
Primary save fails	Existing active rules	Not saved; fix storage and retry
Backup fails after commit	Saved policy retained	Recovery-copy warning
Proof cannot persist	Native locked	Storage issue; coverage needs attention
Chrome stale/permission absent	Coverage warning	Correct profile/permission/extension
macOS hide fails	Guard warning	Affected app; no false success claim
Intentional disconnect	Locked	Rules retained; Reconnect

6.1 Recovery boundaries

A valid last-good copy loads locked. A damaged primary is preserved when restoring. Without a usable backup, cached selections seed a review with a warning that targets may need reselecting.

Failed primary commits retain active in-memory rules. A primary success with a backup failure is reported separately. Runtime corruption or external changes lock using known selections until review.

The bridge checks writable storage. Chrome already holding complete proof may retain it until the next bridge read or original expiry if native storage becomes unavailable; no instantaneous cross-process revocation guarantee is made.

6.2 Controlled validation

Corruption, write failures, missing selections, slow/failed credentials and disconnect races use isolated roots/fake vaults. The real policy was not corrupted, disk was not filled, live key was not deleted and Habitify completion was not manufactured.

7 Installed UI evidence

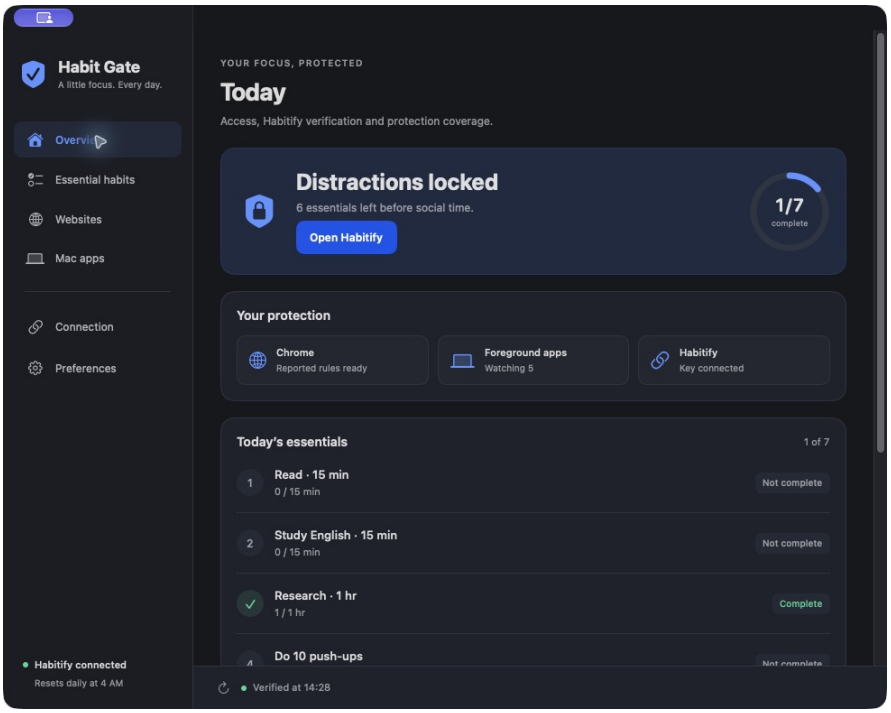


Figure 3: *Installed Overview: explicit lock, remaining count, separate reported coverage and verification. Essentials scroll.*

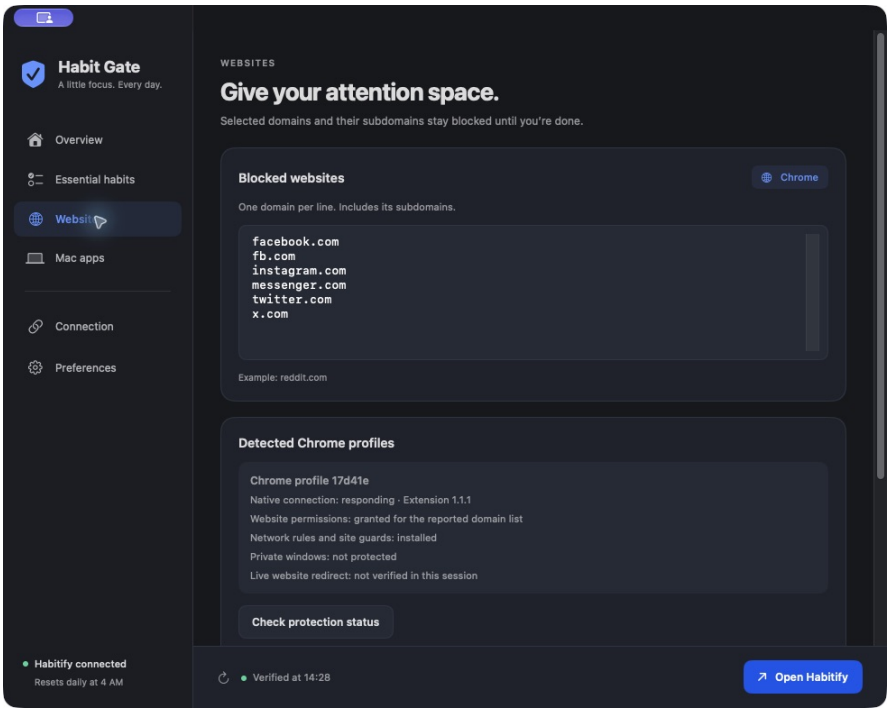


Figure 4: *Installed Websites: 1.1.1, domains permitted, rules installed, private mode off. The in-popup test badge is separate from our external live check.*

8 Rules and foreground protection

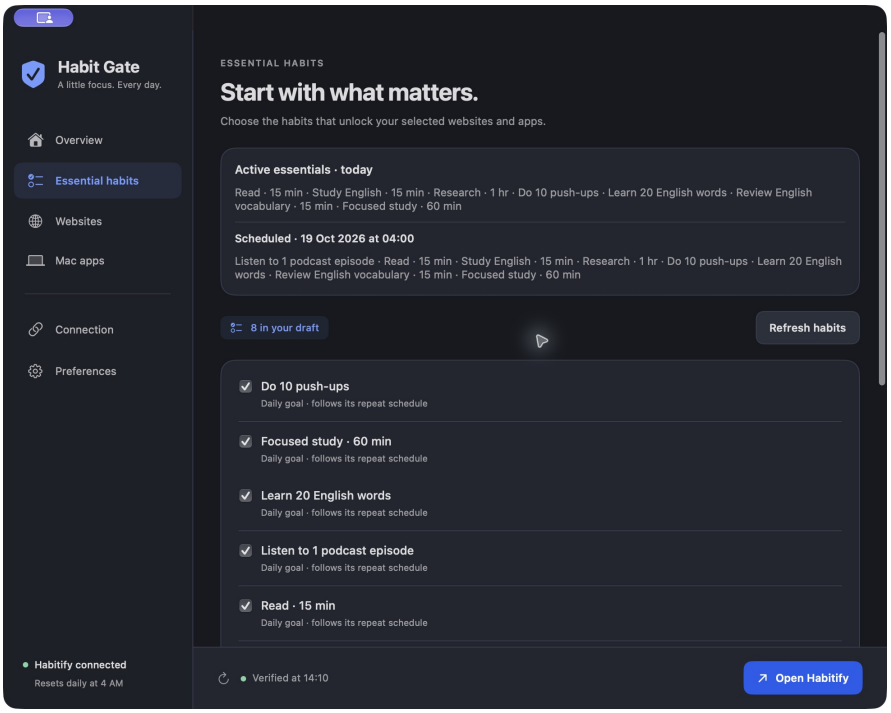


Figure 5: *Installed essentials: active/scheduled names and effective date. Existing saved choices were preserved.*

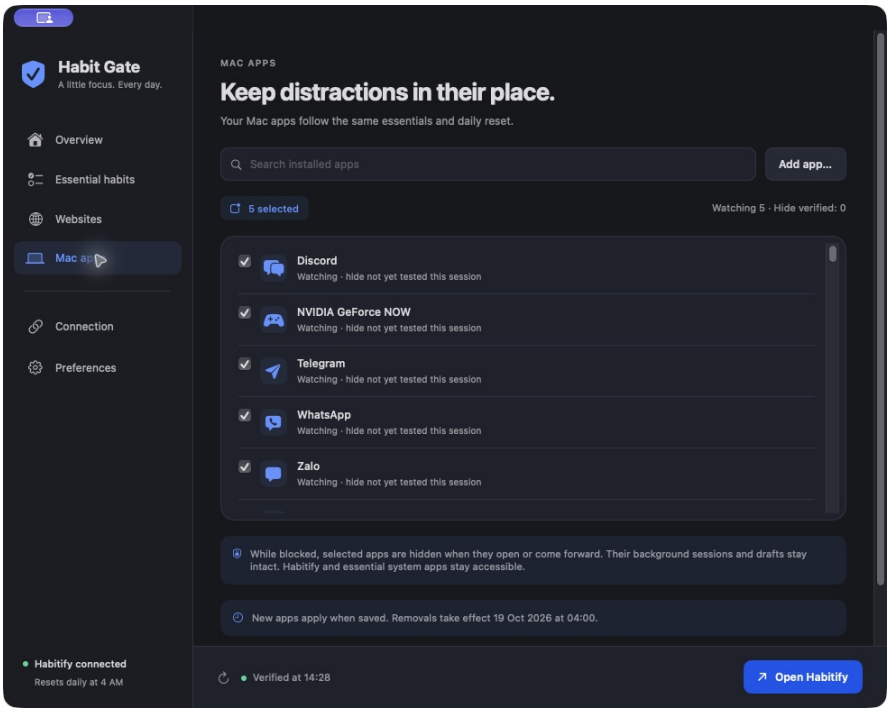


Figure 6: *Installed Mac apps: five watched selections, successful hiding reported separately per session. Background sessions and drafts remain intact.*

9 Connection and reviewed activation

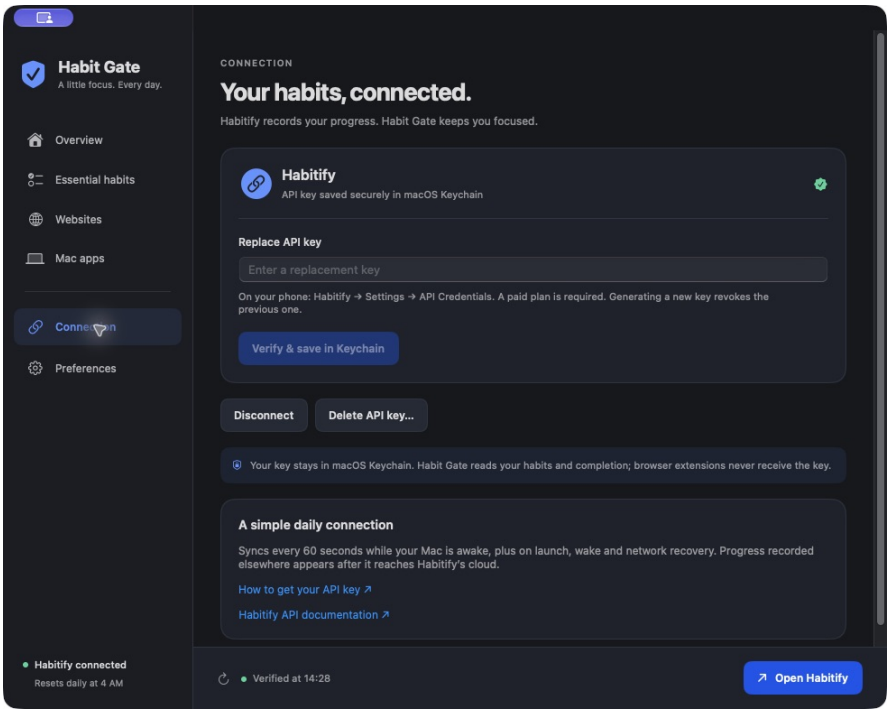


Figure 7: *Installed Connection: Keychain status, disconnect/delete controls and empty replacement field. No secret is shown.*

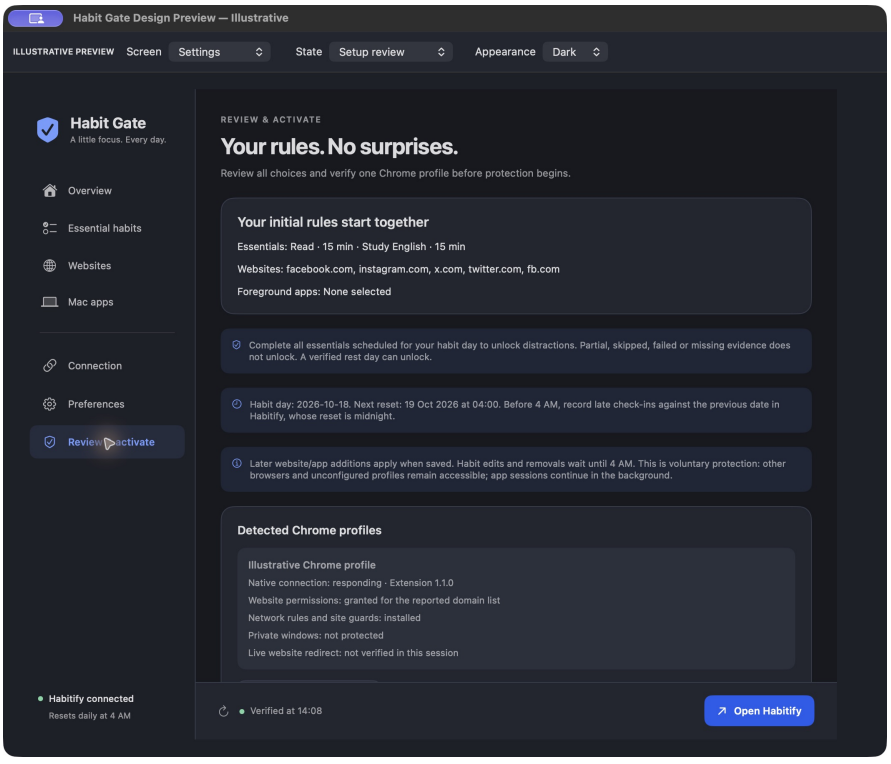


Figure 8: *Illustrative in-memory setup review before activation. This fixture never reads credentials or changes real policy.*

10 Validation and release gates

10.1 Observed evidence

- 61 Swift and 20 browser tests passed, including 12 shared proof fixtures.
- Release build and installed signature, host registration, framing, origin and size checks passed.
- Installed extension assets match source. Policy is unchanged; recovery copy exists.
- Habitify verified at 14:30 local. No journal writes were performed.
- After replacing the old unpacked registration, fresh Chrome reports 1.1.1, six permitted domains, rules installed and no permission issue.
- Messenger reached the blocked page with only its origin retained. Unrelated HTTPS remained usable.
- A scoped scan of 50 app-owned files found no Habitify-key-shaped value. Keychain/Chrome profile storage were not read. This is not a full security audit.

On-disk 1.1.1 did not establish the running version. Reopening Chrome alone failed to replace the stale registration. The native UI exposed this discrepancy accurately.

10.2 Before a community release

Priority	Gate	Evidence / accountable role
P0	Production distribution	Release engineering: signing/notarization, Chrome Store, clean-account installation/update
P0	Live acceptance matrix	Engineering/QA: complete/unlock/undo/relock, 4 AM, midnight, wake/timezone, redirects/existing tabs
P0	Device storage faults	Engineering/QA: full-disk/write-access trial; native/browser agreement
P1	Accessibility	Design/QA: keyboard, focus, VoiceOver, contrast, long text, light/dark
P1	Independent pilot	Product: explain access, timing, scope and recovery without developer assistance
P1	Resource budget	Engineering: current-build warm idle/helper samples; RSS/footprint defined
P1	Privacy hardening	Engineering: minimize bridge metadata; retention/export/deletion

11 Evidence index and reviewer checklist

11.1 Portable Overleaf source

Upload the ZIP as an Overleaf project and compile `main.tex` with pdfLaTeX. Images and evidence are included; no external fonts or shell escape are required.

Record	Purpose
`evidence/UI-UX-REVIEW.md`	Full ID map, Mermaid flows, state table and implementation rationale
`evidence/ux-reliability-update.json`	Versions, tests, fresh coverage, policy preservation, scoped scan and live evidence
`images/installed-*.png`	Real installed screens
`images/setup-review-illustrative.png`	Synthetic setup fixture, labelled illustrative
Earlier engineering review	Historical 1.3.0 requirements, architecture and measurements; supplied separately

11.2 Decisions for review

1. Confirm timing: essentials next 4 AM, target additions now, removals next 4 AM.
2. Confirm foreground hiding and configured-profile Chrome scope fit the voluntary product.
3. Assign owners and pass criteria to the P0 release gates.
4. Observe independent users completing setup and a daily loop.
5. Decide resource acceptance after measuring this build under a declared workload.

Next milestone

A small private pilot with a complete live acceptance record and a production installation path. Keep Safari, general bypass, analytics, rewards and AI deferred.

11.3 Source and authority

The supplied document is requirements input, not evidence. The user's newer timing decision takes precedence over its blanket deferred-change language. This review is supported by source, isolated tests and scoped live observations; it does not assert signing, store acceptance, full accessibility or sustained performance.

Official contracts: https://api-docs.habitify.me/ and https://developer.chrome.com/docs/extensions/reference/api/declarativeNetRequest. Recheck vendor guidance before distribution.